

Your Calcium Scan

Why this test?

A coronary calcium scan uses CT to measure calcified plaque. It can help with selected prevention decisions, including whether cholesterol treatment would be useful.

What to expect

The scan generally does not use IV contrast. Follow the center's preparation instructions, disclose pregnancy possibility, and ask about cost and coverage.

What the number means

Zero means no calcified plaque was found; it does not exclude all plaque or explain away symptoms. Higher scores generally mean more plaque. The score is not a percentage of artery blockage.

What happens next?

Discuss the result alongside cholesterol, BP, family history and other risks. Do not start aspirin or change prescribed treatment from the score alone. Ask whether a repeat scan would change care.

Questions to bring

- Would this scan change my treatment?
- What does the result mean for my personal risk?
- What is our prevention and follow-up plan?

My next step / follow-up: _____

Urgent symptoms: Call 911 for severe chest symptoms, fainting, stroke symptoms or severe trouble breathing. Do not wait for a scheduled test or its report.

Full guide and references: <https://bmorecardiology.com/tests/calcium-score.html>

Source: [ACR/RSNA RadiologyInfo: Cardiac CT for Calcium Scoring](#)

Source: [ACC/AHA: 2026 Guideline on the Management of Dyslipidemia](#)

Independent educational resource. Use your own clinician's instructions.